a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

GRADE 8 · CURRICULUM BOOK

The Year, in One Place

Big ideas, year-at-a-glance, vocabulary, and the project arc.

Year theme: Measure, Improve, Operate Smarter

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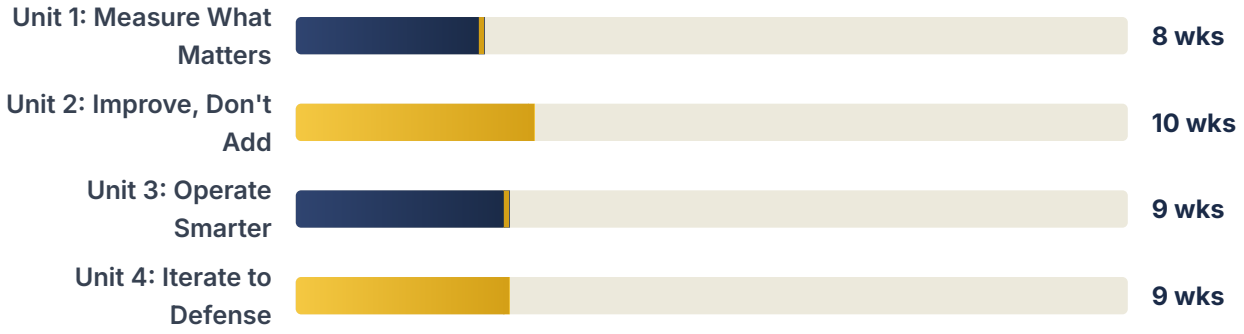
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.

WEEKS PER UNIT · GRADE 8



Each unit closes with a checkpoint artifact. Final defense in Week 36.

36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 8 · CURRICULUM BOOK

The Year, in One Place

A little less wrong, every week.

Year theme: Measure, improve, and operate smarter **Grade band:** 6-8 (middle school, last year) **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 90–120 minutes per week (one block + one short follow-up) **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host

Why this year

"Tell me what they actually said."

— CASH

Eighth graders are ready to run something. Not just imagine it, not just sketch it — actually plan a four-week project, track what really happened against what they said would happen, and explain the gap with a straight face. That capacity to operate — to measure, adjust, and operate smarter — is the muscle Grade 8 builds.

Grade 7 ended with students knowing their customer and their per-customer math. Grade 8 takes those tools and adds three more: a way to invent options on purpose (SCAMPER and How Might We), a way to know when an idea pays for itself (break-even), and a way to learn from running it (Plan-Do-Study-Act). The result is a venture that doesn't just have a customer and a number — it has a system that improves.

The financial spine of the year is **break-even**: the moment a business stops losing money on every customer and starts contributing to the rent. Linear-equation thinking from 8th-grade math drops cleanly onto break-even modeling, so the math classroom and the business classroom share a backbone for the year.

The discipline spine is **PDSA** — the four-step quality-improvement cycle that real operating businesses use. Plan a small change. Do it. Study what happened. Act on what you learned. Then again. Grade 8 is the year students learn that "a little less wrong, every week" is a method, not a mood.

The big ideas (Understanding by Design — Stage 1)

These are the year's load-bearing understandings. Every unit, lesson, and assessment can be traced to one or more of them.

1. **Ideas are products of process.** A good idea is rarely a flash; it's the output of a structured ideation flow with named techniques.
2. **Break-even is a number you can compute.** Once you know unit price, variable cost, and fixed cost, you know the customer count where the business starts paying for itself.

3. **Marketing is an experiment, not a vibe.** A 3-day A/B test with a defined metric beats a year of debating slogans in your head.
4. **A plan is a hypothesis, and variance is the data.** When actuals differ from plan, that gap is information — to be explained, not hidden.
5. **Privacy and safety risks are predictable.** A teen-run online business has a knowable list of things that can go wrong; mitigation is a 3-step plan, not a feeling.
6. **Improvement is a cycle, not a moment.** Plan-Do-Study-Act repeats. Each cycle makes the venture less wrong.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- How do I generate options on purpose, instead of waiting for an idea?
- How do I know — in numbers — when this business pays for itself?
- How do I tell whether my marketing actually worked, or whether I just got lucky?
- When my plan and reality disagree, which one needs to change — and why?
- What can go wrong here that's my responsibility to prevent?
- What did I change this cycle, and what did I learn?

Year-at-a-glance

The year is built as four units. Each unit ends with a public-facing artifact and feeds the rolling Capstone — the Operate-Smarter Venture — that students refine across the year.

Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor artifact
1	1–8	From idea to test	Ideas are products of process.	An Ideation Pack: 10 ideas, 3 finalists, 1 selected, with SCAMPER + HMW evidence.
2	9–18	The break-even truth	Break-even is a number you can compute.	A Break-Even Pack: linear-equation calculator + sensitivity table.
3	19–28	Marketing as experiment	Marketing is an experiment.	A Marketing Test Pack: 3-day A/B test results + first PDSA cycle.
4	29–36	Operate smarter	A plan is a hypothesis; variance is the data.	A Final PDSA Pack: 4-week project plan, variance write-up, peer feedback round, privacy/safety risk plan.

The Capstone (the Operate-Smarter Venture) threads all four units. Students start with a structured ideation flow, build a break-even calculator, run a marketing experiment,

and operate a 4-week sprint with variance tracking and a final Plan-Do-Study-Act cycle.

The eight strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

"Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

— CASH

Grade 8 is the eighth row of the Cash to Company K-12 grid. Every cell below is a specific, measurable outcome a student can demonstrably do by year's end. These are quoted exactly from the Master Scope and Sequence — never paraphrased.

- **BAVC.** I can analyze a business case (1–2 pages) and identify which of three "value levers" (better product, lower price, better experience) it pulled and how.
- **PSIG.** I can run a structured ideation flow (problem → 10 ideas → 3 finalists → 1 selected) using at least 2 named techniques (SCAMPER, "How Might We").
- **MFL.** I can build a simple break-even calculator (units × price = fixed + variable × units) and use it to find break-even volume for a sample business.
- **CBM.** I can run a 3-day mini-marketing test (two posters, two messages) and report which performed better, by what measure, and what I'd do next.
- **OSO.** I can build a 4-week project plan with milestones, owner, and deadline; track actuals vs. plan; and write a 1-page variance explanation.
- **LTO.** I can give and receive a structured peer feedback round using "What's working / What's confusing / One change I'd try" — both directions.
- **ESL.** I can identify one privacy risk and one safety risk in a kid- or teen-run online business and write a 3-step mitigation plan for each.
- **LRCI.** I can complete a Plan–Do–Study–Act (PDSA) cycle on one part of my business and document the change, the result, and the next test.

Each unit braids 3–4 strands. Unit 1 anchors PSIG and BAVC with supporting beams from LTO; Unit 2 centers MFL with CBM (pricing) and BAVC (value levers); Unit 3 centers CBM and LRCI with ESL (honest claims, privacy in tests); Unit 4 centers OSO, LTO, ESL, and LRCI together — the operating year-end.

Vocabulary roadmap (15–25 terms)

Vocabulary in Grade 8 is layered intentionally. Each unit introduces 4–6 new terms; old terms (from Grade 7 and earlier) are recycled. Students keep a Vocabulary Spine in their notebook and build a Frayer entry for each "weight-bearing" term.

Unit 1 (ideation vocabulary): SCAMPER, How Might We (HMW), divergent thinking, convergent thinking, value lever, ideation funnel, finalist, criteria.

Unit 2 (break-even and modeling vocabulary): fixed cost, variable cost, contribution margin (recycled from Grade 7), break-even point, break-even volume, linear equation, sensitivity, scenario.

Unit 3 (experiment and PDSA vocabulary): hypothesis, control, treatment, statistical significance (intuitive only), bias, PDSA, baseline, lift.

Unit 4 (operate-smarter vocabulary): milestone, variance, owner, deadline, RACI (recycled from Grade 6), PII (personally identifiable information), mitigation, retrospective, peer feedback round.

Total: ~25 named terms across the year, plus all Grade 7 terms recycled in context.

Anchor texts

Mix of short readings, video, and case studies. None require purchase; school-friendly substitutes provided.

- The Lean Startup (Eric Ries) — teacher-mediated 2-page summary of the build-measure-learn loop, used to anchor PDSA.
- A short kid-curated case on **In-N-Out vs. McDonald's** — used to surface "value levers" (product, price, experience). Provided in program assets.
- Made to Stick (Chip and Dan Heath) — teacher-mediated 1-page summary of "concrete, credible, emotional" claims, used in Unit 3 messaging.
- A short profile of a teen-run online business that hit a **privacy/safety bump** (anonymized — provided in assets) — used in Unit 4 risk planning.
- A 1-page extract on **Toyota's PDSA roots** (Deming via Toyota Production System) — kid version. Used to introduce continuous improvement as a method, not a slogan.
- One Cash video per unit launch + one mid-unit video (8 across the year — see the Video Scripts file).

Project arc — the Operate-Smarter Venture (Capstone)

Across the year, each student (or pair) develops one venture they can plausibly run. A venture can be a real micro-business, a service, an event, a content product, or a not-for-profit. The Capstone has four checkpoints, one per unit:

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 8): Ideation Pack** — problem statement + 10 ideas + 3 finalists + 1 selected with criteria; named techniques (SCAMPER + HMW) shown.
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18): Break-Even Pack** — linear-equation calculator + break-even volume + 2-scenario sensitivity table.
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 28): Marketing Test Pack** — 3-day A/B test results + analysis + first PDSA cycle on the message.
- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36): Final PDSA Pack** — 4-week project plan with milestones/owners/deadlines, variance write-up, peer feedback round, privacy/safety risk plan with mitigations.

Students choose the venture in Week 2. Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9, 19, and 29 allow students to switch ventures if evidence demands it. Building on Grade 7's customer + per-customer math is encouraged — many students continue refining the same venture they ran in Grade 7, now with break-even modeling and an operating system on top.

Assessment philosophy

"Don't sell. Show."

— CASH

We assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** Did they actually run an A/B test? Did they actually compute break-even with linear equations? Did they actually run a PDSA cycle?
2. **Did the student think about it?** Can they explain their math? Can they name the variance? Can they admit what their test cannot tell them?

The five rubrics in the Rubric Bank are the spine. The Business Plan Rubric anchors Unit 1 and Unit 4 plans. The Budget Project Rubric anchors the Unit 2 break-even calculator. The Customer Research Rubric supports Unit 3's marketing test interpretation. The Pitch Presentation Rubric grades the Final Capstone Defense. The Reflection Writing Rubric grades end-of-unit memos and the Capstone Journal portfolio.

Differentiation in Grade 8

- **ELL.** Linear equations are language-dense (the word "variable" carries math and English meanings). Provide cognate cards (Spanish: variable, costo fijo, equilibrio). For PDSA, sentence frames for the four steps land hard. Allow native-language ideation in SCAMPER; require English in the final Ideation Pack.
- **IEP/504.** The break-even calculator can be built in a spreadsheet template with formulas pre-filled and inputs labeled. Allow voice-recorded variance explanations with transcription support. Reduce ideation count from 10 to 6 if appropriate; the technique discipline matters more than the count.
- **Advanced learners.** Push toward two-variable sensitivity (what if both price and variable cost change?), nonlinear pricing models (bundle discounts), and a second PDSA cycle in Unit 4. Peer-teaching role in Grade 7 classrooms during the contribution-margin unit is an excellent challenge.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **Money topics in case studies.** When analyzing real businesses, frame around "what choices did they make?" — not "how much did the founders earn." Avoid surfacing private wealth.
- **Online-business privacy.** Many Grade 8 ventures will be online (selling on a marketplace, running social-media accounts). The Unit 4 privacy-risk plan is a sensitivity feature: it forces students to think through PII (personally identifiable information), age requirements on platforms, and what they post about themselves. The teacher's job is to surface the risks, not to scare; the family's job is to make platform decisions.
- **Variance and shame.** When actuals miss the plan, students sometimes hide it. Coach: variance is data. The story is in the gap. A Capstone with a clean variance writeup outscores a Capstone where actuals "magically" matched plan.
- **Safety in test environments.** A 3-day in-school A/B test is fine. A 3-day Instagram test on personal accounts is a different conversation. Set norms early.

Materials and tools (year)

- Notebooks (paper or digital) for the Vocabulary Spine and Capstone Journal.
- Break-even calculator template (provided — paper version + spreadsheet version).
- 3-day A/B test template (provided).
- 4-week project plan template with variance column (provided).
- Peer feedback round form (provided).
- Privacy/safety risk plan template (provided).
- PDSA cycle template (provided).
- Access to one Cash short video per milestone (8 total).

- Optional: a spreadsheet tool (Google Sheets, Excel for Web, or paper) for break-even modeling and variance tracking.

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

- **Reaches back to Grade 7.** Grade 7 ended with a customer persona and contribution margin per customer. Grade 8 picks up exactly where Grade 7 left off: contribution margin is the input to the break-even formula, and the customer persona is the input to SCAMPER and How Might We. Strong Grade 7 work makes Grade 8 easier — students who already know who their customer is and what each one contributes are ready to ask "how many customers do I need?" and "what test would tell me my message works?"
- **Reaches forward to Grade 9.** Grade 9 builds the full Business Model Canvas (9 boxes) and runs a customer-discovery cycle with 5 real interviews. The Grade 8 ideation flow, break-even calculator, A/B test discipline, and PDSA cycle are exactly the operating muscles a 9th grader needs to fill the BMC honestly. Grade 9's MVP test (a 2-week experiment with a kill/iterate/scale recommendation) is, in shape, a longer cousin of Grade 8's PDSA cycle.
- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade 8 outcome (see the Master Scope). The four units braid them together — Unit 4, in particular, is where six of the eight strands light up at once.

Standards alignment (centered for Grade 8)

The year explicitly centers the following benchmarks (copied verbatim from the Standards Alignment Map):

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-2:** Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions — extended to running iterative tests.
- **CEE Standard 5 (Financial Investing), Grade 8:** Investors who own a corporation's stock or a corporate bond can earn a return — applied conceptually to "owners take risks for returns."
- **CCSS-Math 8.EE.C.7 / 8.F.B.4:** Linear equations and functions — break-even is a piecewise linear function.
- **CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1:** Patterns of association in bivariate data — used in mini A/B test analysis.
- **CCSS-ELA W.8.1:** Write arguments — variance explanation.
- **C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8:** Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.

- **NGSS-ETS MS-ETS1-3:** Analyze data from tests to determine similarities and differences among several design solutions — direct fit for the A/B test.
- **CASEL Self-Management:** Goal-setting, self-monitoring (PDSA).
- **Honest gap:** PDSA is a quality-improvement discipline not named in standards; we teach it because it's how real businesses get better.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You don't need to be an entrepreneur to teach this. You don't need to have run a business. You need to be willing to enforce three norms: numbers must be computed (not guessed), tests must be honestly named for what they cannot tell, and variance must be explained (not hidden). Cash, in the videos, will model the questions. Your job is to ask them — every time — in the room. By Week 12, students will ask each other.

The biggest pedagogical move you can make in Grade 8 is treating "I don't know yet" as a strong sentence, not a weak one. When a student says "I think A worked better," your move is "what's the number, and what could it not tell you?" When they hit a variance, your move is "what's the gap, and what does it tell you?" The year is built around small, honest answers — not big, performed ones.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 8

Multi-class branching scenario — "Signal or noise?"

A 1-day branching scenario for Unit 3 (marketing as experiment).

- **Setup.** "Two teams ran A/B tests on poster messages last week. Team A: Message A got 8 votes, Message B got 6 votes (14 total people). Team B: Message A got 80 votes, Message B got 60 votes (140 total people)."

Class question: "Both tests show A winning by about 33%. Are both tests equally trustworthy? Why?"

Pair-share. Surface: small samples are noisy. Even with the same percentage, the larger sample is more trustworthy.

- **Pivot.** "What if Team A reran the test the next day and got 6 vs. 8 (B wins)? What does that tell you?" Surface: small samples can flip. The 8-vs-6 result was within noise.
- **Apply to Capstone.** "What's the smallest sample size where you'd start trusting your A/B result? What's the largest sample you can realistically reach?" Most students settle on "at least 30, but I might only get 12 in a school environment."

This scenario practices CBM (A/B test reading), MFL (statistical-significance intuition), LRCI (signal vs. noise). Repeatable in real time during student tests.

Privacy and safety mini-cases for Unit 4

Three case studies for the ESL strand outcome ("identify one privacy risk and one safety risk in a kid- or teen-run online business and write a 3-step mitigation plan").

Case 1 — Etsy at age 14

A 14-year-old wants to sell handmade jewelry on Etsy. Etsy requires sellers to be 18. Privacy risk: name + address visible to buyers. Safety risk: shipping to strangers from home.

Mitigation: parent's account with the kid as the maker; PO Box for shipping; use of a stage name; review reviews before shipping.

Case 2 — Babysitting business

A 13-year-old runs a babysitting service in their neighborhood. Privacy risk: phone number + address shared on flyers. Safety risk: meeting parents you've never met before.

Mitigation: family meets clients first; never the kid alone; emergency contact protocol; no flyers with phone number — referrals only.

Case 3 — Art on Instagram

A 15-year-old sells art on Instagram. Privacy risk: location data in photos. Safety risk: receiving messages from adult buyers.

Mitigation: scrub EXIF data from photos; use a separate "shop" account managed jointly with parent; never give home address; payment through a vetted platform; block anyone whose tone shifts.

These cases meet the standard at full depth and prepare students for real ventures they may run in 9-12.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-2:** "Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions" — extended to running iterative tests.
- **CEE Standard 5 (Financial Investing), Grade 8:** "Investors who own a corporations stock or a corporate bond can earn a return" — applied conceptually to "owners take risks for returns."
- **CCSS-Math 8.EE.C.7 / 8.F.B.4:** Linear equations and functions — break-even is a piecewise linear function.
- **CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1:** "Patterns of association in bivariate data" — used in mini A/B test analysis.
- **CCSS-ELA W.8.1:** "Write arguments" — variance explanation.

- **C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8:** "Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange."
- **NGSS-ETS MS-ETS1-3:** "Analyze data from tests to determine similarities and differences among several design solutions" — direct fit for the A/B test.
- **CASEL Self-Management:** Goal-setting, self-monitoring (PDSA).
- **Honest gap:** PDSA is a quality-improvement discipline not named in standards; we teach it because its how real businesses get better.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim)

By end of Grade 8, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can analyze a business case (1–2 pages) and identify which of three value levers (better product, lower price, better experience) it pulled and how." - **PSIG:** "I can run a structured ideation flow (problem → 10 ideas → 3 finalists → 1 selected) using at least 2 named techniques (SCAMPER, How Might We)." - **MFL:** "I can build a simple break-even calculator (units × price = fixed + variable × units) and use it to find break-even volume for a sample business." - **CBM:** "I can run a 3-day mini-marketing test (two posters, two messages) and report which performed better, by what measure, and what Id do next." - **OSO:** "I can build a 4-week project plan with milestones, owner, and deadline; track actuals vs. plan; and write a 1-page variance explanation." - **LTO:** "I can give and receive a structured peer feedback round using Whats working / Whats confusing / One change Id try — both directions." - **ESL:** "I can identify one privacy risk and one safety risk in a kid- or teen-run online business and write a 3-step mitigation plan for each." - **LRCI:** "I can complete a Plan–Do–Study–Act (PDSA) cycle on one part of my business and document the change, the result, and the next test."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 8)

- **Break-even extension:** Compute break-even at three different price points and graph them. Discuss the price-volume tradeoff.
- **A/B extension:** Design a 4-arm test (4 messages, not 2). Discuss the statistical penalty for multiple comparisons.
- **PDSA extension:** Run two PDSA cycles on the same problem and compare. Did the second cycle test something different than the first?
- **Variance extension:** Compute the variance in percentage terms (actual / plan – 1). Discuss whether 10% is acceptable or alarming.

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

> *"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."*
>
> — CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 8 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 8 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist. The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-1	Identify the components of decision-making and apply them to financial decisions.
CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1	Construct and interpret scatter plots for bivariate measurement data.
CCSS-ELA SL.8.4	Present claims and findings, emphasizing salient points in a focused, coherent manner.
C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8	Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.
CASEL Responsible Decision-Making	Demonstrate curiosity and open-mindedness; analyze information.
CCSS-Math 7.RP.A.3	Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

> *"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."*
>
> — CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
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Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Measure What Matters

Priya runs a tutoring micro-business helping 6th graders with pre-algebra. She has eight regular clients. Five say they would recommend her. Three would not. Her old metric was "hours billed." Her new metric: "would recommend."

The new metric tells a different story. Two of her three non-recommenders share the same complaint: "Sessions feel like quizzes." Priya redesigns the first 10 minutes of every session to start with what the student is stuck on, not what Priya wants to teach. Three weeks later: 7 of 8 would recommend.

What changed? Not effort. Not skill. The metric. "Would recommend" surfaced the experience. Hours billed surfaced nothing.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH, GRADE 8